PRODUCT STRATEGY & OPERATIONS LEADER

Ada Johnson

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Product Strategy & Operations leader with 20 years of experience at Airbnb, Google, Target, and Best Buy. A multiplier: I find the signal in customer, frontline, and operational data, connect it to the right people, and turn individual expertise into collective capability, through feedback loops and operating models that help organizations learn faster and scale responsibly.

CAREER ARC

`Customer-Centric Operator` → `Product & Growth Strategist` → `Scalable Systems Builder` → `AI-Enabled Multiplier`

CORE CAPABILITIES

Product Strategy & Operations | AI-Enabled Systems | AI Workflow Design | Feedback Systems | Operating Models | Voice of Customer | Go-to-Market Strategy | Strategic Partnerships

EXPERIENCE

AIRBNB · 2026 – Present

Manager, Project Implementation | Product Strategy & Operations, Fraud & Safety Delivery

Lead a team of 6 within Airbnb's newly formed Scaled Services organization, extending my Product Strategy & Operations focus to resolve ownership ambiguity across implementation, policy, and operations teams, and build how we measure whether an implementation actually succeeds, not just whether it ships on schedule.

AIRBNB · 2023 – 2026

Manager, Product Operations | Global Fraud & Safety Operations

Led Product Strategy & Operations for Airbnb's global Fraud & Safety operations. Built and led a team of 4 connecting frontline signals to Product and Engineering across 70+ enforcement workflows (identity, safety, financial fraud, account integrity).

- Built an AI-enabled frontline feedback loop: audited 1,360+ agent reports into a library of 1,102 prioritized problems, routed 94% to an owning team, and shipped 20 fixes in 3.5 months, at a median of 31 days for issues that had waited 8.5 months
- Fixes surfaced through the loop helped recover about 2,000 agent hours a month in the largest queue (75% of volume, handle time down 36%) and cut weekly escalations 57% in another
- Designed the prototype that Analytics rebuilt as the Queue Health Monitor (QHM), now Fraud & Safety's official source of truth for weekly and monthly business reviews across all 5 domains; credited by name at launch, it replaced a manual scorecard
- Found that 70 to 88% of agent errors reported in four queues were caused by systems, not agents, redirecting fixes to Product and protecting outsourcing partners from unfair quality scoring
- Built AI workflows for root-cause analysis and business review prep that freed about 20 team hours a week, which let me hand business review ownership to the team

GOOGLE · 2021 – 2023

Strategy & Product Operations Principal | Google Technology & Engineering

Led strategy and transformation initiatives for Google's global frontline technology support organization, redesigning operating models to improve scalability, efficiency, and workforce sustainability.

- Built the strategy and business case to transition 800+ frontline support roles from contractor to employee workforce across 7 global locations, aligning Engineering, Finance, HR, and Legal stakeholders
- Developed prioritization frameworks and executive decision mechanisms that accelerated alignment across complex stakeholder groups

GOOGLE · 2019 – 2021

Strategy & Product Operations Lead | Google One Partnerships

Led global partner strategy and operations for Google One, scaling a consumer subscription product through telecommunications, OEM, and retail partnerships.

- Expanded Google One distribution from 2 to 40+ global partners, supporting an addressable audience of 89M+ users and contributing to 95% subscription growth
- Built repeatable launch frameworks, partner playbooks, and operating rhythms that enabled global expansion across diverse markets
- Translated partner insights, performance data, and customer signals into recommendations influencing product roadmap and growth strategy

FOUNDATIONAL EXPERIENCE

GOOGLE · 2016 – 2019

Product Planning Lead, Google Store · General Manager, West Hollywood Pop-Up · Global Program Manager, Google Merchandise Store

- Grew Merchandise Store revenue 43% over two years on a $14M global program across 48 countries; introduced Google hardware, adding $9M incremental revenue and 81K+ device sales
- Directed 40+ staff to launch Google's first LA pop-up store, beating sales and conversion targets by 5%; created 10+ hardware business plans connecting customer insight to financial opportunity

TARGET CORPORATION · 2012 – 2015

Senior Buyer, Infant & Toddler Furniture · Senior Product Manager, Global Sourcing

- Turned a declining $75M category to +20% year over year; delivered $4M in annual cost savings on a $90M owned-brand sourcing portfolio

BEST BUY CORPORATION · 2006 – 2012

Merchant & Category Strategy | Various Categories

- Co-developed a $5M Batman: Arkham City launch campaign that generated $10M in first-week revenue

LEADERSHIP

- Co-Founder & Lead Organizer, Black in Product Operations @ Google
- Former Alumni Board President & Guest Lecturer, UMN College of Design
- NCAA Division I Track & Field, University of Minnesota (Alumna)

EDUCATION

- MBA, Business Entrepreneurship, Bethel University, Saint Paul, Minnesota
- BS, Retail Merchandising & Business Management, University of Minnesota, Twin Cities